

THE WALL STREET JOURNAL.

DOW JONES | News Corp *****

TUESDAY, JULY 15, 2025 ~ VOL. CCLXXXVI NO. 12

WSJ.com

★★★★ \$5.00

DJIA 44459.65 ▲ 88.14 0.20% NASDAQ 20640.33 ▲ 0.3% STOXX 600 546.99 ▼ 0.1% 10-YR.TREAS. ▼ 1/32, yield 4.426% OIL \$66.98 ▼ \$1.47 GOLD \$3,351.50 ▼ \$4.50 EURO \$1.1667 YEN 147.72

What's News

Business & Finance

◆ **Nvidia said** it has received assurances from the Trump administration that it can sell its H20 artificial-intelligence chip in China, days after CEO Jensen Huang met President Trump. **A1**

◆ **Malaysia tightened rules** around the movement of artificial-intelligence chips from the U.S., a hot-button issue for the Trump administration's trade policy. **B3**

◆ **Financial stocks rose** ahead of big banks' second-quarter earnings reports, helping to lift the S&P 500 and Dow by 0.1% and 0.2%, respectively. The Nasdaq gained 0.3% to notch a record. **B9**

◆ **Private-equity firms** Bain and Kohlberg are leading a new multibillion-dollar investment in PCI, a company that specializes in helping biopharma companies bring new drugs to market. **B1**

◆ **Elon Musk said Tesla** shareholders would vote on investing in xAI, the latest move by the billionaire entrepreneur to tap his own companies to help fund his artificial-intelligence startup. **B1**

◆ **An Italian court lifted** two conditions imposed by officials on UniCredit's bid for Banco BPM, while upholding others. **B9**

◆ **Grayscale Investments,** the cryptocurrency asset manager that helped to popularize bitcoin funds, said it plans to go public. **B3**

◆ **Shoppers in the U.S. and Canada** are walking away from purchases in stores over worries about unsustainable packaging and concerns about plastics, according to a new survey. **B1**

World-Wide

◆ **Trump threatened** to increase economic pressure on Moscow if there is no peace deal with Ukraine in 50 days, underscoring the president's growing anger with Putin as he outlined an agreement to send weapons to Kyiv. **A1**

◆ **The Supreme Court** allowed the Trump administration to begin mass layoffs at the Education Department, halting a lower-court ruling that had blocked the White House's plans. **A2**

◆ **The Trump administration** is attempting to make millions of immigrants living in the country illegally ineligible to be released from detention on bond as they fight their deportation cases. **A3**

◆ **Israel said its military** struck several tanks in southern Syria as clashes between Bedouin gunmen and Druze militias left dozens dead and injured in the latest eruption of sectarian violence in the country. **A6**

◆ **Former New York Gov.** Andrew Cuomo plans to run for New York City mayor as an independent after his surprise loss in the Democratic primary to Zohran Mamdani last month. **A4**

◆ **At least nine people** died and many residents were taken to local hospitals after a fire in an assisted-living facility in Fall River, Mass. **A3**

◆ **A wildfire forced** the Grand Canyon National Park's North Rim to close for the remainder of the 2025 season and destroyed the historic landmark lodge in the park. **A2**

◆ **Died: Andrea Gibson,** 49, poet and performance artist **A2**

CONTENTS	Markets..... B9
Arts in Review..... A11	Opinion..... A13-15
Business & Finance B2	Personal Journal A9-10
Business News..... B3	Sports..... A12
Crossword..... A11	Technology..... B5
From Page One..... A8	U.S. News..... A2-5
Heard on Street..... B10	World News..... A6-8,16



© 2025 Dow Jones & Company, Inc. All Rights Reserved

Three Cheers for the Bleu, Blanc et Rouge



NATHAN LANE/BLOOMBERG NEWS

ARCHETYPES: French military units marched near the Arc de Triomphe in Paris on Monday for the parade celebrating Bastille Day. President Emmanuel Macron has pledged to accelerate national defense spending to counter threats in Europe.

Dimon Warns on Private Credit But Wants JPMorgan to Jump In

With \$50 billion bet, bank expands lending to riskier companies as market grows

By ALEXANDER SAEEDY

Jamie Dimon says Wall Street's hottest trend is a recipe for a financial crisis, but he's investing billions to get in on it anyway. His plan: swoop in strategically and profit if there's a meltdown.

In the ballroom of the Loews

Hotel in Miami Beach, Dimon got on stage in front of hundreds of clients in February to talk about the boom in unregulated lending to highly indebted companies. This fast-growing market has been sidelining big banks for years, and JPMorgan Chase's chief executive said it reminded him of the craze in subprime mortgages that sparked the 2008 financial crisis.

"Parts of direct lending are good," Dimon said at the event, according to people who attended. "But not everyone does a great job, and that's what

causes problems with financial products." He said that in the 2008 financial crisis, Bear Stearns and Lehman Brothers got in late, made bad choices and "bought these two sh—y little mortgage companies," leading eventually to "everything" blowing up.

The comparison was jarring. Just hours earlier, JPMorgan had announced it was investing \$50 billion in private credit, more than a decade after financial firms such as Blackstone and Ares Management, which aren't banks, kicked off the

boom in lending to financially risky companies. Banks have typically shied away from this business because of stiff regulations meant to protect depositors.

The most successful banker in generations, Dimon has earned respect on Wall Street and beyond for steering JPMorgan away from financial fads that toppled other firms. Economists and some central bankers

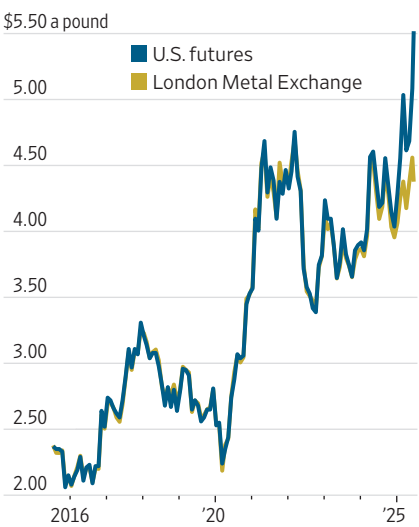
Please turn to page A8

◆ **Heard on the Street: Big banks aren't best oracle..** B10

Copper On Fast Track

The surge in U.S. copper prices since Trump's tariff pledge has spurred a race to develop new mines for the metal. Even without tariffs, copper prices are expected to climb because of booming demand to build data centers, renewable-energy installations and electric cars. **B1**

Copper prices, monthly



Note: London price converted from metric tons
Source: FactSet

Dollar's Drop Costs Americans Some Buying Power Overseas

By JACK PITCHER AND JOE PINSKER

U.S. tourists have grown accustomed to their dollars traveling well, too. This summer, they are getting a wake-up call.

The ICE U.S. Dollar Index, which compares the U.S. currency to a basket of six others, just posted its worst first half of a year in more than 50 years. The dollar has declined 13% against the euro this year and 6% against the Japanese yen. It is a stark reversal of the

conditions that greeted U.S. travelers and investors as recently as 2024, when a strong dollar lifted their purchasing power on imported goods, triggered a travel boom and fueled talk of the U.S.'s economic dynamism.

That was before the Trump administration's trade policies, concerns over the growing national debt and the shrinking gap between interest rates in the U.S. and other major economies began to weigh on the dollar. Many expect the world's reserve cur-

rency to drop further.

And while its decline has made exports cheaper (a boon to U.S.-based industry) and opened opportunities for people in the U.S. to invest in foreign stocks, it has made traveling overseas more costly than it has been in years.

So far, many travelers are still packing their bags. A

Please turn to page A4

◆ **Tariff threat puts Europe in a bind.....** A2
◆ **Trade truce with U.S. lifts China's exports.....** A8

Inside Operation 'Cattitude': A Mission to Understand Cats

Pet food maker tackles 'feline insecurity' as ownership of mercurial creatures surges

By NATASHA KHAN

The pet food giant had a problem. Cats were rapidly catching up to dogs as America's favorite pets, but the company was filled with people who didn't fully understand the mercurial creatures—or their owners.

So Mars launched a mission to get its dog-loving workers inside cats' heads.

As part of an internal operation called "Cattitude," the maker of Whiskas food and Temptations treats organized visits from vets and animal nutritionists. There were power point presentations. Staffers were paired with cat parents. One afternoon, senior bosses walked around the office with cat ears.

The goal: Reorient the en-

tire team—from those who formulate new products to those putting together advertisements—around one of cat parents' chief sources of angst: "feline insecurity," a fear of cats' indifference to their owners' affection. (Type "Does my cat" into Google, and the top search is "love me." The second is "know I love her.")

Cat parents say that for too long, the world has misguidedly treated their pets like dogs with smaller bodies and less need for attention. But as Gen Z spurs a surge in cat households, cat culture is getting a closer look.

"We need to drive cats back up to the spotlight they deserve," said Helen Hastings, a Mars executive who helped spearhead the Cattitude cam-

Please turn to page A10



Purrplexing

Nvidia Wins OK On China Chip Sales

By RAFFAELE HUANG AND AMRITH RAMKUMAR

Nvidia said it has received assurances from the Trump administration that it can sell its H20 artificial-intelligence chip in China, days after Chief Executive Jensen Huang met President Trump.

The turnaround comes after the Commerce Department had restricted sales of the chip in April, costing Nvidia billions of dollars. It is welcome news for the \$4 trillion chip company and Huang, who is visiting Beijing this week.

The administration said Nvidia would be allowed to sell the H20 chip after licenses are granted by the Commerce Department, according to the company. Nvidia said it would begin deliveries soon. In addition,

Please turn to page A4

Can the French Revamp U.S. Department Stores?

By KATE KING

The U.S. department-store model is broken. A French operator that recently opened a flagship store in New York City thinks it has a better one.

Printemps New York is following the European department-store playbook of serving up enough food and drinks, exhibitions and other activities to keep shoppers occupied far beyond the fitting room.

The store in Manhattan's financial district was designed to evoke a luxurious Parisian residence. It more closely resembles a chic nightclub than it does a suburban Macy's. The new store features an espresso cafe under a green-and-white circus tent, three other restaurants, hand-painted tiles, a champagne bar and spa chairs for mini-facials and head massages.

At 55,000 square feet, the New York store is less than half the size of a typical U.S. department store. It also has

far less floor space dedicated to clothing racks and cosmetics counters.

"We said, 'it's going to be an apartment store, not a department store,'" Printemps Group Chief Executive Jean-Marc Bellaiche said.

It is too early to say whether Printemps's museum-grade decor and its philosophy of combining dining, art and retail can win over U.S. shoppers.

But the traditional U.S. department store model has been in decline for decades. After peaking at nearly \$97 billion in 1999, the industry's annual sales had fallen 69% by the end of 2023, according to the U.S. Census Bureau.

Earlier iterations of the U.S. department store sold everything from car parts to toiletries and were prized by mall owners for their ability to draw crowds of shoppers.

But competition from discount and specialty stores eroded department stores' *Please turn to page A4*

Trump Threatens Economic Pressure On Russia

President says he wants peace in 50 days as he outlines arms deal to Ukraine

President Trump threatened Monday to increase economic pressure on Moscow if there is no peace deal with Ukraine in 50 days, underscoring his growing anger with President Vladimir Putin of Russia as he outlined a deal to send weapons to Kyiv.

By Alexander Ward, Lara Seligman and Robbie Gramer

The U.S. will impose "very severe tariffs if we don't have a deal in 50 days," Trump said.

Commerce Secretary Howard Lutnick later said Trump could choose to impose either tariffs or sanctions on countries that do business with Russia. "Those are both tools in his toolbox," Lutnick said.

It is unclear if Putin will take Trump's threat seriously. The Republican president has repeatedly promised action against Russia within two weeks if he deemed Putin un-serious about signing a peace agreement. There is also the possibility that Trump could postpone penalizing countries that trade with Russia, such as India and China, when the 50-day deadline is reached on Sept. 2.

The threats came as Trump said the U.S. reached a deal *Please turn to page A7*

◆ **Ubiquity of drones freezes front lines.....** A7
◆ **U.S. official wants focus on China over Ukraine.....** A16